

PRACTICAL TEST AUTOMATION WITH PLAYWRIGHT

Automation Best Practices Checklist

A quality bar for every automated test you write.

Introduction

Use this checklist as a quality bar before committing any test. It captures the habits that separate a maintainable suite from one that becomes a burden.

Per-Test Checklist

- Tests one clear behaviour
- Named by behaviour + expectation
- Independent — no reliance on other tests or order
- Creates and cleans up its own data
- Uses user-facing locators (role/label)
- Uses web-first assertions, no manual sleeps
- Asserts a user-visible outcome
- Runs reliably (passes on repeat-each)

Suite-Level Checklist

- Organised by feature with clear naming
- Shared setup via fixtures, not copy-paste
- baseURL and config make it environment-portable
- Runs in CI with artefacts on failure
- No quarantined/flaky tests left unaddressed

Worked Example

Before committing a new checkout test you confirm: one behaviour, clear name, unique data with cleanup, role-based locators, web-first assertions, and a clean pass on `--repeat-each=5`. It is ready.

Practical Exercise

Run one of your tests through the per-test checklist and fix any item it fails.

Best Practices

- Treat the checklist as a definition of done for tests.
- Refactor toward it continuously.
- Keep the suite trustworthy above all.

Common Mistakes

- Committing tests that pass once but are not reliable.
- Copy-pasting setup instead of using fixtures.
- Letting flaky tests linger.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

A trustworthy suite is worth more than a large one. Ten reliable tests teams act on beat a hundred that get ignored because "they always fail anyway".